displaying static data and there's no real logic. In that case, MVC adds complexity without any real benefits, as there's not really any logic in the controllers at all. Another great use case is when you're creating forms for users to submit data. Razor Pages is especially optimized for this scenario, as you saw in previous chapters.

Clearly, I'm a fan of Razor Pages, but that's not to say they're perfect for every situation. In the next section I discuss some of the cases when you might choose to use MVC controllers in your application. Bear in mind it's not an either-or choice; it's possible to use MVC controllers, Razor Pages, and even minimal APIs in the same application, and in many cases that may be the best option.

19.5.2 When to choose MVC controllers over Razor Pages

Razor Pages are great for building page-based server-side rendered applications. But not all applications fit that mold, and even some applications that *do* fall in that category might be best developed using MVC controllers instead of Razor Pages. These are a few such scenarios:

- *When you don't want to render views*—Razor Pages are best for page-based applications, where you're rendering a view for the user. If you're building an HTTP API, you should use minimal APIs or MVC (web API) controllers instead. You'll learn about web API controllers in chapter 20.